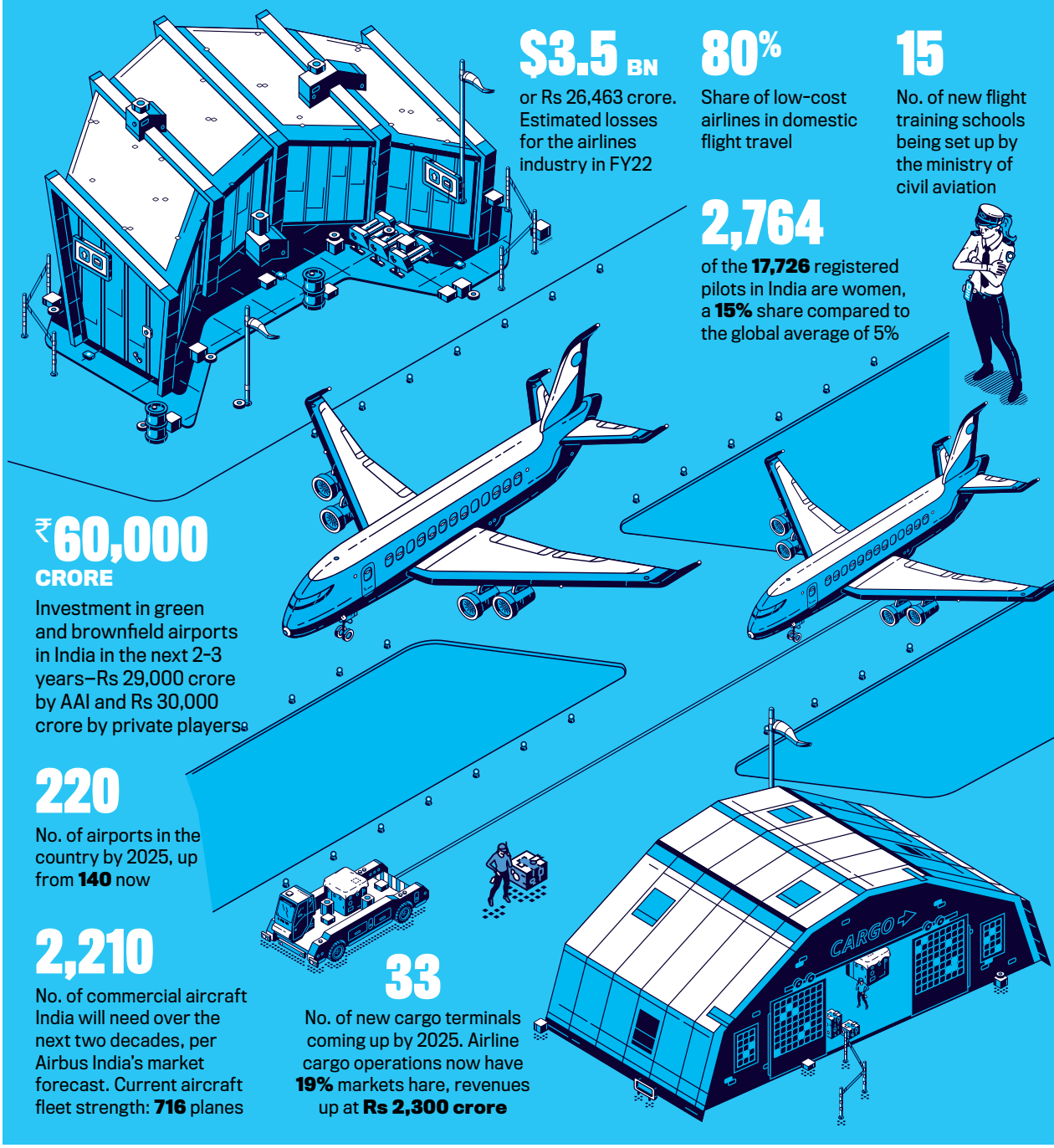
AIR TRAVEL MAKES A COMEBACK

It's been the toughest two years for any business. And aviation is a risky business at the best of times—a time when zero human mobility was mandated can only have been death-knell. But now the sector is looking up again. Domestic air traffic is showing signs of a quick revival: data shows an average daily traffic of 382,000 passengers in the week starting March 20. India was the fastest growing aviation market globally before Covid struck. Civil aviation minister Jyotiraditya Scindia foresees passenger traffic rising to 400 million by 2023-24. The sector has "an economic multiple of 3.1 (a yield of 3.1 dollars for every dollar invested) and an employment multiple of 6.1," he says. A list of the ministry's estimates and plans:

Text by **AMARNATH K. MENON**



$3.5 BN
or Rs 26,463 crore. Estimated losses for the airlines industry in FY22

80%
Share of low-cost airlines in domestic flight travel

15
No. of new flight training schools being set up by the ministry of civil aviation

2,764
of the **17,726** registered pilots in India are women, a **15%** share compared to the global average of 5%

₹60,000 CRORE
Investment in green and brownfield airports in India in the next 2-3 years—Rs 29,000 crore by AAI and Rs 30,000 crore by private players

220
No. of airports in the country by 2025, up from **140** now

2,210
No. of commercial aircraft India will need over the next two decades, per Airbus India's market forecast. Current aircraft fleet strength: **716** planes

33
No. of new cargo terminals coming up by 2025. Airline cargo operations now have **19%** markets hare, revenues up at **Rs 2,300 crore**

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

Source: Ministry of Civil Aviation